

Another report says that 66 per cent of B2B and 52 per cent of B2C customers stopped buying from a brand after a bad customer service interaction.

Provides element of trust: When your business has good customer service in place, customers trust you more. Trust could make all the difference in the world of business. When customers trust you more, they are likely to remain loyal to your brand and product.

Provides value: The customer service team provides value to your business by treating customers well, answering questions, and building strong relationships. Customers understand that they are the source of revenue for your business, and they want to feel appreciated.

Is AI a big deal for customer service?

AI is revolutionising the future of customer service in many ways. It is not just limited to chatbot or auto-answering; it is much beyond, as described in the next section. AI supports and works alongside humans, enables a business to grow in a cost-effective way, and promotes the best possible customer experience. By assigning simple and repetitive tasks to AI machines and allowing humans to focus on customers that require complex issues or assistance, companies are able to improve customer services leading to improved customer experiences, enhanced brand reputation, and well-informed actions.

Some of the advantages of AI include auto-answering, 24-hour service, faster decisions, handling voluminous data, and boosting efficiency.

Auto-answering: Auto-attendant is a common feature in office telephone systems. It is an important part of your business. It is typically the first point of contact with your customers. Similarly, AI-based voice bots and chatbots are used in modern communication devices.

24-hour service: One of the key benefits of an AI chatbot is that it never sleeps. It is there to help customers resolve their issues at any time. This is important for companies operating globally and looking to provide better customer service and support. Humans can get tired and demotivated after answering the same repetitive questions. AI is perfectly suited for repetitive and menial tasks like tagging tickets. Most of the time, the bot is able to resolve the query, but in situations where it cannot, it is passed on to the humans.

Handling data: Companies are collecting more data than ever about their customers. But it's difficult for humans to accurately analyse the vast amount of unstructured data. AI and machine learning can derive quantitative data and respond to customers much faster than humans.

Faster decisions: When customer service is available round the clock with a vast amount of data, AI platforms can find answers quickly and respond to queries faster.

Boosting efficiency. Even if your brand has an experienced customer service team, AI can still lend a hand behind the scenes. Using natural language processing, AI can read a ticket and direct it to the right team much faster than a human triage system can.

Some use cases of AI in customer service

Voicebot: It is based on AI and is a more advanced version of an auto-attendant system. It is great for handling automated tasks that involve numbers and simple yes/no answers. Voicebot with natural language understanding (NLU)-based voice channel for communication works by converting audio to text format. For example, Dialogflow CX, recently launched by Google, is used for building text and voice-based AI agents for mobile apps, websites, and Google Assistant actions. A user can speak to the virtual

agent naturally, and it will process the information and respond appropriately. Another example is the AI-powered voice bot 'TIA' launched by Tata Capital on WhatsApp.

AI chatbot: The AI-based human-like bot that pops up on the website to start an online chat is becoming a common feature on most business websites. The chatbot can be integrated on websites, messaging applications, mobile apps, and kiosks. These bots play a vital role in the simplification of human interactions with the computers and customer interactions with the business, providing engaged self-service.

As per some reports, 60 per cent of online customers do not like to wait for more than 60 seconds for a response to their query. The use of chatbots drastically reduces customers' waiting time and provides a quicker solution to their queries, thus improving customer experiences. Chatbots with Natural Language Processing or NLP capabilities are used to handle customer complaints through faster responses, thus elevating customer satisfaction.

For example, the AI-based COTA (customer obsessed ticket assistant) system built by Uber helps customer support representatives improve their speed and accuracy, resulting in improved customer experience. It is found that with the AI system, ticket routing efficiency is increased by ten per cent.

Big companies like Google, Microsoft, Facebook, and others are all actively engaged in the race to build chatbots that can respond to customer queries.

Customer identifications: These include biometrics, and face and voice recognition. Biometrics refers to body measurements, authentication, identification, and access control. Facial recognition identifies and verifies an individual by comparing facial features from a digital image or video to a database.